It’s an emergency!

TASK 1

What would you do?

Answer the questions with a partner. Give reasons.

English File Upper-intermediate, Student’s Book p. 44, ex 1a

TASK 2

How do you eat an elephant?

Guess the answer with your partner. What do you think it means in an emergency?

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student’s Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 3

Read the article

Read the article on p. 45. **Answer** the questions.

1. What is the key to surviving a life-or-death crisis?

2. What is the 10-80-10 principle?

3. Apart from keeping calm, what else is important?

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student's Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 4

Words from the article

Find the highlighted words in the article. **Match** them to the meanings.

English File Upper-intermediate, Student's Book p. 45, 'How to eat an elephant'

1. unable to react because the situation is too strong _____
2. so shocked that you can't think clearly or act _____
3. a new or difficult thing that tests your abilities _____
4. very confused _____
5. based on reason, not emotion _____
6. to succeed in dealing with a problem _____
7. to not get excited or nervous; not to panic _____
8. pieces of work you are able to deal with _____

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TASK 5

Strong feelings

Listen to the dialogues. **Choose** the stressed syllable in each adjective. Then practise the dialogues with a partner.

English File Upper-intermediate, Student's Book p. 45, ex 3 (dialogues); audio track 3.5

Track 3.5 · the dialogues
Your teacher will play the recording.

1. **desperate** _____
2. **offended** _____
3. **disappointed** _____
4. **bewildered** _____
5. **astonished** _____
6. **delighted** _____
7. **devastated** _____
8. **horrified** _____
9. **overwhelmed** _____

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student's Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 6

It's an emergency!

In threes: you are A, B or C. **Read** your survival tips only. Note what you should and shouldn't do, and why.

Student A: an emergency on a plane

Student B: lost on a hike in the mountains

Student C: somebody breaks into your house

YOU SHOULD…	YOU SHOULDN'T…

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student's Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 7

Tell your group

In your own words, tell the others how to survive your emergency. Don't read. They listen and ask one question each.

Use: *The most important thing is… · You should never… · Experts say… · If you…, you'll…*

TASK 8

The rules of survival

In groups, rank the rules from 1 (most important) to 8. You must all agree.

Stay calm and breathe.	_____
Have a plan before anything happens.	_____
Stay where you are and wait for help.	_____
Tell someone where you are going.	_____
Do one thing at a time.	_____
Always carry water and a phone.	_____
Trust your instincts.	_____
Never try to be a hero.	_____

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student's Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 9

What now?

In groups: choose an emergency. Plan exactly what you would do, step by step. Then **tell the class**. The class decides: would you survive?

You are stuck in a lift with five strangers. The alarm doesn't work.

Your kitchen is on fire and the smoke is getting thick.

You lose your little cousin at a big music festival.

Your car breaks down on a desert road at night, with no phone signal.

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